JAMES CHRISTOPHER HARRINGTON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Principal Engineer with 8 years of hands-on experience building scalable backend systems and leading technical architecture decisions across fintech and SaaS platforms. I've spent the last four years focused on cloud infrastructure modernization and mentoring senior engineering teams through complex system redesigns. I'm pragmatic about technology choices, preferring proven solutions over bleeding-edge frameworks, and I enjoy the challenge of taking legacy monoliths and incrementally transforming them into maintainable microservices. Currently based in Bristol and looking for opportunities to lead technical strategy at the principal level.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

Thoughtworks

www.thoughtworks.com

Bristol, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Architected and led the migration of a £2.5M revenue platform from a monolithic Node.js application to a distributed microservices architecture, reducing deployment time from 45 minutes to 8 minutes

Established coding standards and design review processes across 12-person engineering team, reducing production incidents by 34% year-over-year

Mentored 4 junior engineers through advanced system design concepts and guided 2 engineers to promotion to senior roles

Designed and implemented a comprehensive observability stack using Datadog and custom dashboards, enabling rapid incident response and root cause analysis

Senior Backend Engineer

Synthio Limited

www.synthio.io

Bristol, United Kingdom

July 2019 - February 2022

Built REST APIs and event-driven services in Python and Go handling 2.5 million requests per day across healthcare sector clients

Reduced database query times by 58% through intelligent caching strategies and query optimization, improving end-user experience significantly

Led adoption of event sourcing patterns for critical data workflows, ensuring system auditability and compliance with GDPR requirements

Contributed to hiring and onboarding of 6 new engineering team members during company growth phase

Backend Developer

Meridian Systems Group (Previously known as Alpine Digital Solutions)

Alpine Digital Solutions was acquired by Meridian Systems Group in 2021

London, United Kingdom

September 2016 - June 2019

Developed customer-facing APIs in Python and Java for mobile banking application used by 180,000 active users

Implemented comprehensive unit and integration test coverage increasing from 42% to 89%, dramatically reducing regression bugs in production

Optimized PostgreSQL database schemas and wrote migration scripts for zero-downtime deployments affecting 50+ services

Collaborated with product team to define API contracts and versioning strategy, enabling smoother releases across multiple client platforms

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science

University of Bristol

Bristol, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2016

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, Java, JavaScript, SQL, Bash

Backend and Architecture: Microservices design, Domain-Driven Design, Event sourcing, REST APIs, gRPC, system design, distributed systems, database optimization

Cloud and Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda), Google Cloud Platform, Docker, Docker Compose, CI/CD pipelines, GitHub Actions

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, MongoDB, Elasticsearch

DevOps and Orchestration: Kubernetes, Terraform, ArgoCD, infrastructure as code, monitoring and observability

Tools and Platforms: Git, Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, Datadog, New Relic, Grafana, Prometheus, Jenkins

Soft Skills: System architecture, technical mentorship, code review leadership, cross-functional collaboration, incident management